PRECISION TIMING / ENGINEERING SOFTWARE

MHM2010 / T4
Maser Timing Workbench

Operator and Scientific Manual

FITS and Franks timing, reference 1 PPS figures, MHM2010 DDS/drift and

T4 iMaser 3000 SETFSREL/DRIFTCOMP suggestions, T4 MONIT telemetry and
the T4's own monitoring files,
stability and native Veusz output against MJD and local ISO time.

Application version	0.2.3 (0.2.2, 0.2.1, 0.2.0 and 0.1.0 content retained below)
Bundled writer	`vszh5_writer.py` 0.0.27 (registry master 0.0.28 writes the same files)
Author	William W. Wallace
Date	November 10, 2026
Runtime	Python 3.12 (tested also on 3.13)
GUI	qtpy / PySide6 / pyqtgraph
License	GPL-3.0-or-later

Review boundary. This application never sends a setting to a maser. The T4 panel can send only the documented read-only queries MONIT, RDFS, GETID and RDREG. Numerical candidates are advisory and require verification of the current settings, sign conventions, reference behavior and application epoch. Historical examples are not settings to enter today.

Deliverable contract: runnable source; live interval fitting; both drift units; FITS and Franks timing inputs; HMD context; stability; Stable32; native `.vszh5`; bookmarked PDF and editable LuaLaTeX; tested examples and a 7z package. Physical instrument certification is outside this release.

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Purpose and verified instrument relationship

The instrument mapping follows the MHM2010 manufacturer's guide [1]; stability definitions follow NIST SP 1065 [2]; and interchange files follow the Stable32 manual [3]. These references establish the analytical framework, not a certification of the installed system.

The workbench estimates residual maser-to-reference fractional frequency and frequency drift from measured timing offsets. Housekeeping telemetry identifies instrument context and changes; it is not an independent frequency reference. The Green Bank system logs switched one-pulse-per-second comparisons involving Site1Hz, MicroSem and GPS channels [4].

The MHM2010 manual gives the exact relationship between maser oscillation frequency, the external synthesizer number and the standard output frequency. An increase in the synthesizer number lowers output frequency; the nominal calibration is 7.04024×10^{-17} per least-significant displayed digit [1]. The application derives its local gain from the exact denominator, rather than treating the nominal calibration as exact.

The supplied screenshot identifies the two target controls as **External DDS Setting** and **Drift Correction**. The manufacturer's manual explicitly offers **DDS Units/day** and **pp** 10^{18}**/day** in the drift control [1]. Both are computed simultaneously in this release.

Documented item	Treatment in this release
DDS versus output direction	Increasing DDS decreases output frequency [1].
DDS precision	One displayed last digit is 10^{-7} in the synthesizer number [1].
Drift-unit choices	Both DDS units/day and parts in 10^{18}/day are available [1].
External control	Front-panel synthesizer selection must permit external control [1].
Drift-field sign	Not explicitly stated in inspected Rev. J; user selects and verifies it.
Numeric limits and cadence	Not specified in inspected Rev. J; not invented by this program.
Housekeeping selector codes	Retained as raw logged values; not decoded into an enable assertion.

Review boundary. A phase offset cannot be removed merely by selecting a zero steady frequency error. This software does not plan phase slews or write the instrument. It estimates slope and curvature and leaves the constant phase offset unchanged.

Release structure

- **Application**: GUI entry point plus separate input, science and export modules.
- **Batch path**: `analyze_maser.py` accepts explicit paths and historical assumptions.
- **Writer**: the supplied native h5py writer, with a targeted date-shape fix.
- **Documentation**: this PDF, its LuaLaTeX source, README, changelog and validation report.
- **Examples**: a 30-day historical result with raw pair datasets, reports and Stable32 output.

Installation and first run

Use Python 3.12 in an isolated environment. No fixed personal directory names are embedded in the application. Run the following inside the extracted package:

```
py -3.12 -m venv .venv
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install -r requirements.txt
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe MHM2010_Correction_App.py
```

The supplied Windows launcher uses the adjacent environment if present, otherwise Python's 3.12 launcher. Source files have author/revision headers, semantic versions, Spyder cell markers and explanatory comments. In Spyder, select the same environment; a dedicated console is preferable if a GUI loop is already active.

The default backend is PySide6 through qtpy. The application does not import PySide6 directly. pyqtgraph is configured to match the selected Qt backend. PyQt6 may be selected explicitly through `QT_API`, but that alternate backend was not validated for this release.

Dependencies and offline behavior

The runtime requirements are NumPy, SciPy, pandas, Astropy, h5py, QtPy, PySide6 and pyqtgraph. The supplied environment-version list records the packages used for testing. Installing dependencies requires package access; the scientific analysis itself requires no web service, API key, instrument socket or serial connection.

Veusz is optional for viewing or rendering output, not for generating `.vszh5`. Test dependencies include pytest and AllanTools. The included manual was compiled with LuaLaTeX; run the command twice from the docs folder:

```
lualatex -interaction=nonstopmode -halt-on-error MHM2010_Workbench_Manual_v0.1.0.tex
```

Quick workflow

1. Select raw OnePpsDeltas FITS/FITS.GZ files using the GUI or drag-and-drop.
2. Load HMD housekeeping separately; select the intended MicroSem/GPS pair.
3. Choose a continuous acquisition run and a clean fit interval.
4. Compare linear and quadratic behavior and inspect residuals and other references.
5. Enter the DDS and enabled drift at the intended application epoch.
6. Verify signs and operating state; inspect both drift-unit representations.
7. Compute stability with an explicit sampling tolerance and detrending choice.
8. Export to a new results folder and retain the source hashes and review record.

Review boundary. This release was tested in a Linux cloud environment. Actual Windows file dialogs, display scaling, Stable32 application import and physical maser operation remain untested. No connected bracca device was exposed at the last inventory check, so local staging was not performed.

Input data and provenance

Preferred input: raw OnePpsDeltas FITS

The parser requires the `OnePpsDeltas` binary table with `DMJD`, `CHANNELA`, `CHANNELB` and `DELTAT`. It verifies UTC time metadata and declared time/phase units. Files marked simulated are rejected. Blank channel names, nonpositive timestamps and padding rows are rejected. FITS `TNULL` values are honored when supplied.

Every measured channel pair stays separate. The direct `MicroSem -> CNS_GPS1` pair is preferred over subtracting sequential Site1Hz observations. Reverse-direction pairs are not merged into the direct pair: their measurements occur at different times and can include fixed channel-path asymmetries. Valid raw zero values and -9999 ns observations are not automatically treated as missing.

Rows are sorted by timestamp. Identical duplicates are removed and counted; different values at one identical pair timestamp cause a failure rather than an arbitrary choice. The parser records input basenames, sizes and SHA256 hashes, without exporting personal absolute directory paths.

Alternative input: Franks t00new

Franks files are reduced timing data. The parser locates the named MJD header, requires the nanosecond declaration and preserves each available timing column. Values -9999 and the historical -999 sentinel are removed in this adapter only. Raw FITS and reduced Franks files cannot be loaded as one combined batch.

Hourly median timestamps are often irregular. They can be fitted using actual timestamps, but cannot automatically be treated as a uniform stability record. The original reduction windows and raw samples cannot be recovered from the reduced values.

HMD telemetry

HMD is parsed as a timestamped comma-delimited table. It must include MJD and the external synthesizer column. All numeric housekeeping channels remain available for display. Large discrete DDS changes and selector-code changes are marked as candidate events; gradual drift ramps are not called steps.

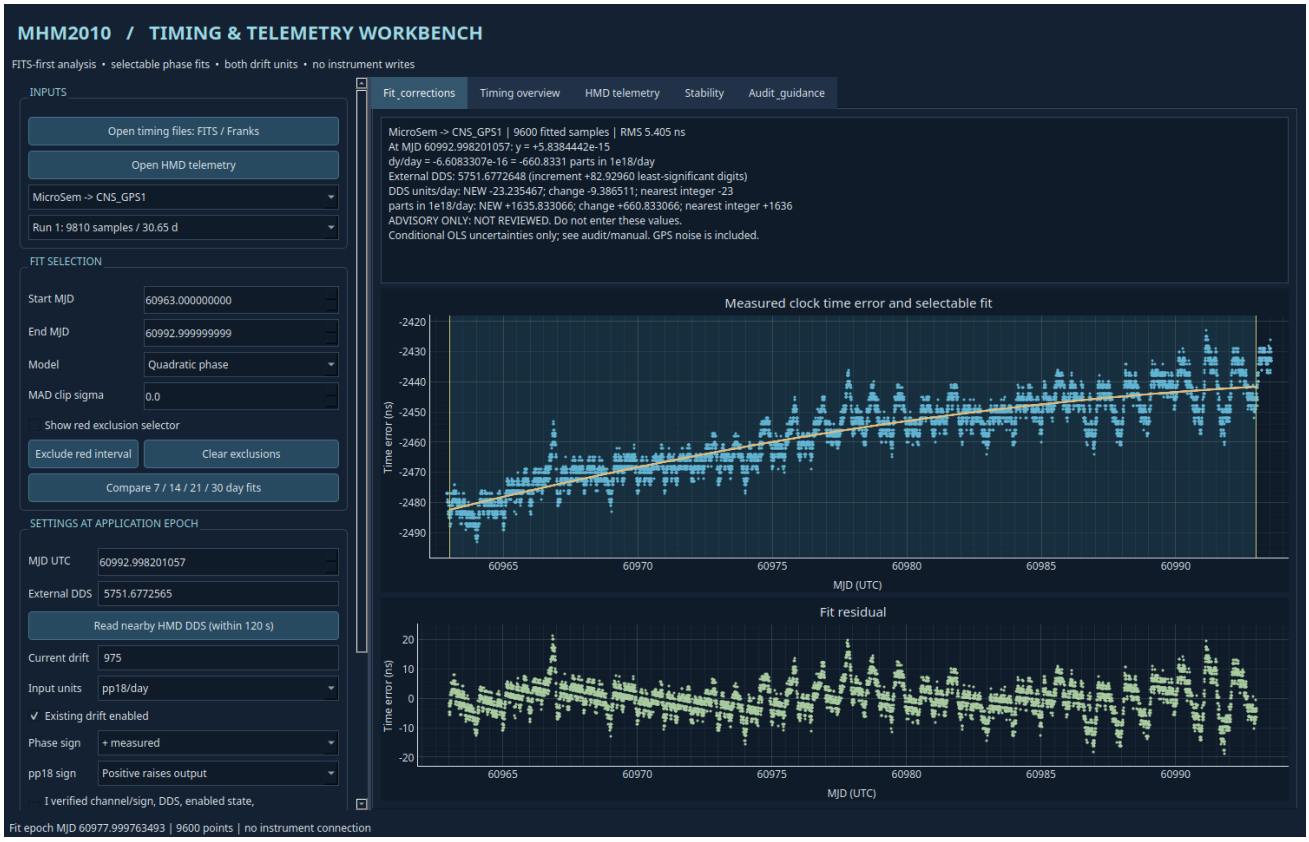
The event detector uses a configurable function argument with a GUI default of 50 least-significant DDS digits. This is an application heuristic, not a manufacturer alarm threshold. Alarm/status channel voltages remain raw values. Missing HMD coverage is reported; historical telemetry is never silently used as the current state at an unrelated epoch.

Timing overview and the supplied Veusz exemplar

The overview creates UTC-hour medians for available Site1Hz comparisons, direct MicroSem/GPS measurements and a separately labeled difference of Site1Hz medians. All raw measured pairs remain in the export. Missing channels such as RA or TAC are not fabricated.

Each available overview channel has MJD and proper UTC-axis export pages. This reproduces the useful dataset families in the supplied Franks Veusz example without copying its all-missing channels or invalid legacy dates. UTC-hour binning is not claimed identical to the historical reduction windows.

Interactive analysis



Fit and corrections tab. The blue region selects the fitting interval. The phase and residual plots share their horizontal view. Numeric MJD limits provide precise selection without requiring a mouse.

The red region is an independent exclusion selector. Add its interval to the exclusion list or clear the list. Excluded observations remain in the input and export, with an explicit used-in-fit mask. Optional iterative MAD residual clipping is disabled by default. It can reject outliers, but it changes noise statistics and must not conceal physical events.

A linear phase model estimates frequency only; the drift field is not estimated and should not be changed on that basis. A quadratic phase model estimates frequency and frequency drift. Internal scaling improves numerical conditioning without changing the physical units of the returned coefficients.

The 7/14/21/30-day comparison button reports trailing-window fits in the audit tab. These are unclipped quadratic diagnostic fits, with actual span and sample count shown. They are not confidence intervals.

State and stale-result handling

Changing the fit interval/model invalidates old stability results. Settings can be saved without source-directory paths, then restored after selecting the original files. Restoring settings clears operator acknowledgments. Export creates a new folder; it never silently replaces an earlier result directory.

Review boundary. The plots are interactive analysis of selected files, not streaming acquisition. Large file reads run outside the GUI thread; fitting, overview construction and export may briefly occupy the GUI thread for very large datasets. There is no serial or network maser interface in this release.

Correction interpretation and manual review

One epoch, two absolute settings

The phase fit is centered on an internal reference epoch. Frequency error is evaluated at the separate intended application epoch. The old DDS must be the setting at that application epoch, not the setting at the start of the data or at the centered fit epoch.

The new external DDS is an **absolute setting**, not a number to add again. Its displayed increment is also reported in least-significant DDS digits. The new drift is the existing enabled drift plus a residual correction, with the sign and units handled explicitly. An existing disabled drift contributes zero regardless of a stale numeric value in its field.

The pp18/day input field and DDS-units/day input field are alternative representations of the same ramp. The program reports both new values and both increments. Do not apply both increments sequentially.

Sign and precision

For the adopted timing definition, measured arrival(B) minus arrival(A) equals clock(A) minus clock(B). A direct MicroSem-to-GPS pair therefore uses the positive sign; a reverse pair uses the negative sign. This channel interpretation must be checked against the installed measurement wiring and logging convention.

Positive physical DDS units/day means the DDS number increases with time, which lowers output frequency [1]. The installed pp18 sign is separately selectable: positive raises output frequency, or positive raises DDS. The default is an explicit assumption, not a claim that Rev. J documents that sign.

The external DDS is rounded to seven decimal places. Both drift values are also shown without integer rounding and with nearest-integer alternatives. The integer alternatives are illustrative: verify what entry precision the installed masermon accepts. pp18 integer increments and DDS integer increments do not have the same effective frequency-drift resolution.

Before entering any candidate

- **Reference**: confirm the GPS channel is healthy, not stepped or being steered unexpectedly.
- **Instrument**: confirm external synthesizer selection, current DDS, drift enable state and units.
- **Sign**: verify the instrument's installed pp18 convention; do not test it by an uncontrolled adjustment.
- **Time**: use a current, defensible application epoch and known setting at that epoch.
- **Fit**: inspect residuals, HMD changes, outages and window sensitivity.
- **Record**: preserve old settings, intended values, operator review and subsequent comparison data.

No checkbox turns this software into a certified controller. Values remain advisory even after the operator review fields are acknowledged.

Stability analysis and Stable32

OADEV, MDEV, TDEV and OHDEV use phase samples in seconds and the NIST SP 1065 definitions [2]. The calculation supports raw phase, mean removal, linear phase removal and quadratic phase removal. Results are labeled with the chosen detrending; raw stability must not be confused with fitted-residual stability.

The code validates both adjacent intervals and cumulative deviation from a uniform grid. It never fills gaps or interpolates samples. The mean actual interval establishes the nominal sampling period after validating the record. The default relative tolerance is 1%; the interface allows up to 5%. This is an explicit approximate-uniformity tolerance, not proof that jitter has no effect at the shortest averaging times.

For the supplied month, a 2% tolerance admits an approximately 3 s maximum grid deviation on a 270 s cadence. The default 1% rejects the full record. An internal exclusion creates a missing interval and is not compressed away to make a false uniform series.

At least ten contributing terms are required for each plotted estimate. Overlapping terms are correlated; their count is not an equivalent number of independent degrees of freedom. No confidence bands or maser-only noise separation are claimed [2].



Stable32 files

`raw.PHD` holds phase seconds and `raw.FRD` holds fractional frequency derived from successive phase samples. The frequency record has one fewer point. Fit-residual versions are written separately. The headers contain type, point count and tau; companion CSV/JSON files retain original timestamps, units, tolerance checks and export decisions [3].

Stable32 treats embedded zeros as gaps. Actual zeros are exported as `1e-99`, following the manual's recommendation; replacements are counted in the sidecar [3]. Do not use its gap-fill controls to disguise a nonuniform or incomplete input record.

Output package and reproducibility

Output	Meaning
`analysis.vszh5`	Native HDF5 document, typed datasets and Veusz plotting script.
`analysis.json`	Fit, coefficients, conditional covariance, settings, both drift units, provenance and warnings.
`phase_and_fit.csv`	All input timing samples, model, residual, selection and fit masks.
`telemetry_overlap.csv`	HMD rows overlapping the selected timing interval, if present.
`stability.csv`	Estimator, tau, deviation and overlapping-term count.
`raw.PHD / raw.FRD`	Optional uniform-record Stable32 phase and fractional frequency.
`fit_residual.*`	Separately identified residual stability inputs.
`review.md`	Human-readable advisory summary and reference table.

The HDF5 document is written using the supplied writer without importing Veusz. All measured raw pair datasets and descriptive labels are included when the full collection is exported. Overview medians are separate datasets. The example's externally rendered PDF is a preview, not a dependency of the application.

Exports first build in a temporary adjacent folder and rename only after success. An existing destination is rejected. This protects earlier results on ordinary local filesystems; no distributed-filesystem transactional guarantee is claimed.

Batch operation

```
python analyze_maser.py --fits-directory <FITS_DIRECTORY>
  --hmd <HMD_FILE> --start 2025-10-15 --end 2025-11-14
  --derive-dds --drift 975 --sampling-tolerance .02
  --stable32 --output <NEW_OUTPUT_DIRECTORY>
```

Join the lines for the shell. The end time is exclusive. Without DDS and drift inputs, the batch path exports measurement results without a correction candidate. `--derive-dds` only copies an HMD setting within 120 s of the historical application epoch; it does not retrieve present-day state.

Writer revision

The attached writer was version 0.0.21. A targeted test demonstrated that `dataset_date()` accepted multidimensional input, creating invalid date shape or silently flattening it in resizable mode. Version 0.0.22 adds one-dimensional validation before creating the dataset group. Valid callers retain the same API. This is a scoped defect correction, not an exhaustive review of every writer feature.

Release 0.2.0 shipped 0.0.24 (MJD and local ISO time axes). Release 0.2.3 ships 0.0.27, copied unchanged from the operator's FitsAutoPlot folder (SHA-256 `992e46a4…40be2369`); it names graphs and traces after their data. The registry master 0.0.28 differs only in saving speed and writes identical files; see `docs/vszh5_writer_0.0.27_NOTES.md`.

Historical validation results

The uploaded archive contains 109 FITS.GZ files and 40 measured channel pairs, 9,810 records per pair. The example selects October 15 through November 13, 2025, producing 9,600 direct MicroSem-to-CNS_GPS1 samples. The HMD record covers April 9, 2025, through March 25, 2026. The previously supplied July 2026 timing files do not overlap that HMD record.

At the last selected sample, November 13, 2025, 23:57:24.571 UTC, the quadratic fit gives frequency error $+5.83844 \times 10^{-15}$, residual drift -660.833 parts in 10^{18}/day and phase-residual RMS 5.405 ns. These are computed results from the supplied files, not external instrument specifications.

Review boundary. The example assumes enabled drift $+975$ pp18/day and a positive pp18 sign that raises output frequency. The older screenshot supplies that example number, but does not establish its value in November. The following candidates are historical and unapproved.

Quantity	Historical example
HMD DDS near the last timing sample	5751.6772565
Calculated DDS increment, last digits	+82.929597
New rounded DDS	5751.6772648
New drift, pp18/day	+1635.833066
Equivalent new drift, DDS units/day	-23.235467
Nearest integer pp18/day alternative	+1636
Nearest integer DDS units/day alternative	-23

The dominant warning: fit-window sensitivity

Window, d	Frequency error at common end	Drift, pp18/day	RMS, ns
30	$+5.83844 \times 10^{-15}$	-660.833	5.405
21	$+3.80025 \times 10^{-15}$	-883.575	5.810
14	$+1.39421 \times 10^{-14}$	+407.199	5.922
7	-4.32655×10^{-15}	-5454.180	6.970

The drift changes sign with the fitting interval. Conditional OLS errors are much smaller than this variation and must not be interpreted as a complete uncertainty budget. A longer/reference-checked operating-state review is needed before any live adjustment.

For the 30-day window, CNS2018 and CNS_GPS2 comparisons give -688.966 and -652.571 pp18/day. Similar values are useful but do not demonstrate independent references or isolate maser aging.

Cross-checks, testing and limitations

Franks/Veusz comparison

The supplied Veusz example was read as HDF5 data, without executing its embedded plotting script. Across 735 matching UTC-hour bins in the full archive span, the new derived MSM–GPS comparison differs by 1.284 ns RMS from the historical reduced values. MicroSem and CNS_GPS1 differ by 0.852 ns and 1.004 ns RMS. Median differences are approximately zero. The maximum absolute differences are 4, 2 and 4 ns respectively.

These small differences are consistent with nonidentical reduction windows and rounding, but that explanation is not a proof of identical processing. The direct raw pair remains the primary correction input. Invalid negative MJD legacy records and all-missing channels in the exemplar were not copied.

Automated and rendering checks

The delivered suite has 36 passing tests on Python 3.12. Tests cover analytic phase coefficients, DDS direction, quantization, both drift representations, disabled drift, reversal, duplicates, gap/grid rejection, clipping, FITS metadata/padding, Franks sentinels, GUI controls/settings, writer behavior and export protection.

OADEV, MDEV, TDEV and OHDEV were compared with AllanTools for seeded synthetic phase data, including contributing-term counts. The 29-page historical `.vszh5` was opened and rendered with a separate Veusz installation. Its PDF has page bookmarks. GUI captures document the offscreen Qt tests.

Not validated

- **Windows/bracca**: actual desktop operation and local staging were not performed.
- **Stable32 executable**: output structure was checked, but proprietary-application import remains a site test.
- **Installed masermon**: sign, range, precision, update cadence, persistence and firmware/version behavior remain site checks.
- **Physical system**: no live adjustment, calibration or post-adjustment monitoring was conducted.
- **Uncertainty**: no colored-noise confidence intervals, reference-error removal or independent maser-aging measurement is claimed.

Repository provenance

The RF_Equipment_Comms stability-tool code [5] and FitsAutoPlot sources [6] were read for header, GUI and analysis conventions. The science modules in this package are new implementations using the cited definitions, not a wholesale copy of the signal-analyzer tool. Repository checkouts were read-only with respect to their remotes; no push was performed.

Reviewed commits:

- RF_Equipment_Comms: `9305e94e9ad85dbdb94a3765cf0989449dc3f345`.
- FitsAutoPlot: `36add38d973bc07e920ff70680a139241c421f7c`.

The product-page pointer is Microchip MHM-2010 [7].

Appendix A: Implemented equations

Time, phase and polynomial fit

Let t be elapsed SI seconds, obtained by converting UTC timestamps through TAI, and d elapsed days from fit epoch t_0. The MJD plotting conversion is only a civil-date coordinate; it is not used for elapsed-time derivatives.

$$t_i - t_0 = \mathrm{TAI}(\mathrm{UTC}_i) - \mathrm{TAI}(\mathrm{UTC}_0), \qquad d_i = (t_i - t_0)/86400, \tag{A1}$$

$$v_i = 86400(\mathrm{MJD}_i - 54832), \qquad h_i = \lfloor 24\,\mathrm{MJD}_i \rfloor. \tag{A2}$$

Here v_i is the Veusz seconds coordinate relative to 2009-01-01 and h_i indexes a UTC-hour reduction bucket. Within each nonempty bucket, time and phase are reduced by their medians:

$$(\widetilde{\mathrm{MJD}}_h, \widetilde{x}_h) = (\mathrm{median}_{i:h_i=h}\,\mathrm{MJD}_i,\ \mathrm{median}_{i:h_i=h}\,x_i)\,. \tag{A3}$$

With phase coefficients in nanoseconds and d in days:

$$\widehat{x}(d) = 10^{-9}(c_0 + c_1 d + c_2 d^2)\ \mathrm{s}, \tag{A4}$$

$$y(d) = \frac{10^{-9}}{86400}(c_1 + 2c_2 d), \qquad r \equiv \frac{dy}{dd} = \frac{2c_2\,10^{-9}}{86400}\ \mathrm{day}^{-1}. \tag{A5}$$

For a linear fit, c_2 is not estimated; the drift result is withheld, not presented as evidence of zero physical drift.

Let $s = \max_i |d_i|$, $A_{ij} = (d_i/s)^j$, $b_i = 10^9 x_i$, and let $T = \mathrm{diag}(1, s^{-1}, s^{-2})$, truncated for a linear fit:

$$\widehat{\boldsymbol{\beta}} = \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\beta}} \|A\boldsymbol{\beta} - \mathbf{b}\|_2^2, \qquad \mathbf{c} = T\widehat{\boldsymbol{\beta}}, \tag{A6}$$

$$\widehat{\sigma}^2 = \frac{\sum_i e_i^2}{N - p}, \qquad C_c = T\left[\widehat{\sigma}^2 (A^{\mathsf{T}}A)^{-1}\right] T^{\mathsf{T}}, \qquad e_i = b_i - (A\widehat{\boldsymbol{\beta}})_i. \tag{A7}$$

Here p is coefficient count. The reported fit scatter and conditional uncertainties are:

$$\mathrm{RMS}_{\mathrm{ns}} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{N}\sum_i e_i^2}, \qquad \sigma_y = \frac{10^{-9}}{86400}\sqrt{\mathbf{g}^{\mathsf{T}} C_c \mathbf{g}}, \qquad \mathbf{g} = (0, 1, 2d)^{\mathsf{T}}, \tag{A8}$$

$$\sigma_r = \frac{2\,10^{-9}}{86400}\sqrt{(C_c)_{22}}. \tag{A9}$$

They assume IID residuals conditional on the chosen fit; they do not represent a full timing-standard uncertainty.

Clipping, continuity and channel convention

Optional clipping uses median-centered residuals and a robust scale:

$$M = \text{median}(e), \quad S = 1.4826 \text{ median } |e - M|, \quad \text{retain } i \text{ if } |e_i - M| \le kS. \tag{A10}$$

There are at most eight clipping passes, followed by a final refit. $k = 0$ disables clipping. A fitting run is split at gaps exceeding five median timestamp intervals:

$$\Delta\text{MJD}_i > 5\,\text{median}(\Delta\text{MJD}). \tag{A11}$$

These are software heuristics, not manufacturer operating limits.

For ideal pulse arrival times and clock time errors relative to the same reference:

$$\Delta t_{A\to B} = t_{\text{arrival},B} - t_{\text{arrival},A} = x_A - x_B, \qquad x_{\text{maser}-\text{ref}} = \epsilon\,\Delta t, \quad \epsilon \in \{-1, +1\}. \tag{A12}$$

Fixed cable offsets affect the constant phase term; changing delays can affect slope and drift and are not removed automatically.

DDS correction and both drift units

The manufacturer relationship is [1]:

$$f_o = \frac{f_m}{D}, \qquad D = 284.08 + aN, \qquad a = 2 \times 10^{-7}. \tag{A13}$$

For old DDS N, measured residual fractional frequency y, and least-significant DDS step $q = 10^{-7}$:

$$k_N = \frac{a}{D}, \qquad \frac{\delta f_o}{f_o} \simeq -k_N \delta N, \qquad g_{\text{digit}} = -k_N q, \tag{A14}$$

$$\Delta N = \frac{D}{a} y, \qquad N_{\text{new}} = \text{round}_q(N + \Delta N), \qquad \Delta n = \Delta N / q. \tag{A15}$$

Before rounding, the static relation exactly cancels the measured residual:

$$1 + y_{\text{new}} = (1 + y)\frac{D}{D_{\text{new}}}, \qquad D_{\text{new}} = 284.08 + aN_{\text{new}}. \tag{A16}$$

The quantization residual is computed from (A16) with Decimal arithmetic. The physical DDS rate v, in last digits/day, transforms as:

$$v_{\text{new}} = (1 + y)v_{\text{old}} + \frac{r}{k_N q}. \tag{A17}$$

Let P be the displayed pp18/day value and $\eta = +1$ when positive P raises output frequency, or -1 when it raises DDS:

$$v_{\text{old}} = -\frac{\eta P_{\text{old}} 10^{-18}}{k_N q}, \qquad P_{\text{new}} = -\eta\, v_{\text{new}}\, k_{N,\text{new}} q\, 10^{18}, \tag{A18}$$

$$P_{\text{new}} \simeq P_{\text{old}} - \frac{\eta r\, 10^{18}}{1 + y}, \qquad k_{N,\text{new}} = a / D_{\text{new}}. \tag{A19}$$

The code reports the rounded-DDS conversion in the both-units table. An inactive old drift uses $v_{\text{old}} = 0$. These equations describe the local rate at the application epoch, not undocumented firmware scheduling.

Rounding, uniformity and Stable32 conversion

For nearest-integer drift alternatives:

$$\delta r_v = -(\text{round}\, v_{\text{new}} - v_{\text{new}}) k_{N,\text{new}} q, \tag{A20}$$

$$\delta r_P = \eta(\text{round}\, P_{\text{new}} - P_{\text{new}}) 10^{-18}. \tag{A21}$$

For a record of N samples, interval tolerance ρ, and time coordinates from (A1), the validation is:

$$\tau_0 = \frac{t_{N-1} - t_0}{N-1}, \qquad \max_i \left| \frac{t_{i+1} - t_i}{\tau_0} - 1 \right| \le \rho, \tag{A22}$$

$$\max_i |t_i - t_0 - i\tau_0| \le \rho\tau_0, \qquad 0 < \rho \le 0.05. \tag{A23}$$

At least eight finite matching samples are required. No missing interval is compressed or interpolated. Stable32 fractional frequency and actual-zero encoding are:

$$\overline{y}_i = \frac{x_{i+1} - x_i}{\tau_0}, \qquad z_{\text{export}} = \begin{cases} 10^{-99}, & z = 0 \text{ (actual observation)}, \\ z, & z \neq 0. \end{cases} \tag{A24}$$

The zero convention follows Stable32's documented gap handling [3].

Stability estimators

Let $\tau = m\tau_0$, with integer $m \ge 1$, and x_i phase seconds. All sums are over valid overlapping terms of a validated complete record. The implementations follow NIST SP 1065 [2]:

$$\sigma_y^2(\tau) = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{N-2m-1} (x_{i+2m} - 2x_{i+m} + x_i)^2}{2\tau^2(N-2m)}, \tag{A25}$$

$$\operatorname{mod}\sigma_y^2(\tau) = \frac{\displaystyle\sum_{j=0}^{N-3m} \left[\sum_{i=j}^{j+m-1} (x_{i+2m} - 2x_{i+m} + x_i) \right]^2}{2m^2\tau^2(N-3m+1)}, \tag{A26}$$

$$\sigma_x(\tau) = \frac{\tau}{\sqrt{3}} \operatorname{mod}\sigma_y(\tau), \tag{A27}$$

$$\sigma_H^2(\tau) = \frac{\displaystyle\sum_{i=0}^{N-3m-1} (x_{i+3m} - 3x_{i+2m} + 3x_{i+m} - x_i)^2}{6\tau^2(N-3m)}. \tag{A28}$$

The displayed OADEV, MDEV and OHDEV are square roots of the respective variances. TDEV is (A27). Averaging factors are log-spaced integers, with duplicates removed and at least ten contributing terms per reported point. Optional detrending subtracts an OLS polynomial of order 0, 1 or 2 before applying these equations; raw mode removes only a constant for numerical convenience.

What is new in release 0.2.3

- **Both suggestions, always.** The MHM2010 has two adjustments, the external DDS and the drift field; the T4 has `SETFSREL` and `DRIFTCOMP`. The workbench now states both changes together, at the application epoch, in the Results box, in a box on the reference fit figure (GUI and both Veusz fit pages) and in every export. The changes need no current settings; with the current DDS and drift field entered the new absolute values are added.
- **Exports never round.** Every number written to a CSV, Stable32 file, `review.md`, JSON or Veusz text dataset is the exact float64; every number in a figure box is also a dataset.
- **Names and tags.** Datasets are named `<Source>_<item>_<quantity>[_<unit>]` and tagged `source_*` and `type_*`; traces and graphs carry the same names.
- **Veusz display.** Numeric axes show up to 12 significant digits; the HMD export holds every column; constant series are padded.

Suggested settings: frequency and drift

Equations

From the selected phase model $x(\tau) = a_0 + a_1\tau + a_2\tau^2$ (ns, τ in days from the fit epoch, elapsed SI time) and the channel sign ϵ, at the application epoch τ_a:

$$y = \epsilon\,\frac{(a_1 + 2a_2\tau_a)\,10^{-9}}{86400}, \qquad D = \epsilon\,\frac{2a_2\,10^{-9}}{86400}\ \text{per day}. \tag{S1}$$

With (A13)–(A19), $k_N = a/D_N$, $D_N = 284.08 + aN$, $q = 10^{-7}$ and η the pp18 sign convention:

$$\Delta n = \frac{D_N}{a}\,\frac{y}{q} \quad \text{(DDS change, counts)}, \tag{S2}$$

$$\Delta P = -\eta\,\frac{D}{1+y}\,10^{18} \quad \text{(drift change, pp18/day)}, \tag{S3}$$

$$\Delta v = \frac{D}{k_N q}\ \big(+\,v_{\text{old}}\,y \text{ when the current field is in DDS counts/day}\big) \quad \text{(drift change, DDS counts/day)}. \tag{S4}$$

Without a DDS setting the nominal $D_N = 284.08$ is used (a relative change of 4×10^{-6} at $N = 5752$). With the current values: $N_{\text{new}} = \text{round}_q(N + q\Delta n)$ and drift field = current + change. T4: `SETFSREL` from Eq. 12 of [8] (39-bit step) and $\texttt{DRIFTCOMP}_{\text{new}} = \texttt{DRIFTCOMP}_{\text{now}} - D$ [9]. A linear model estimates no drift; the box then says so. The arithmetic is the same as `correction()` and `t4_settings()` (tested to 10^{-13} or identical).

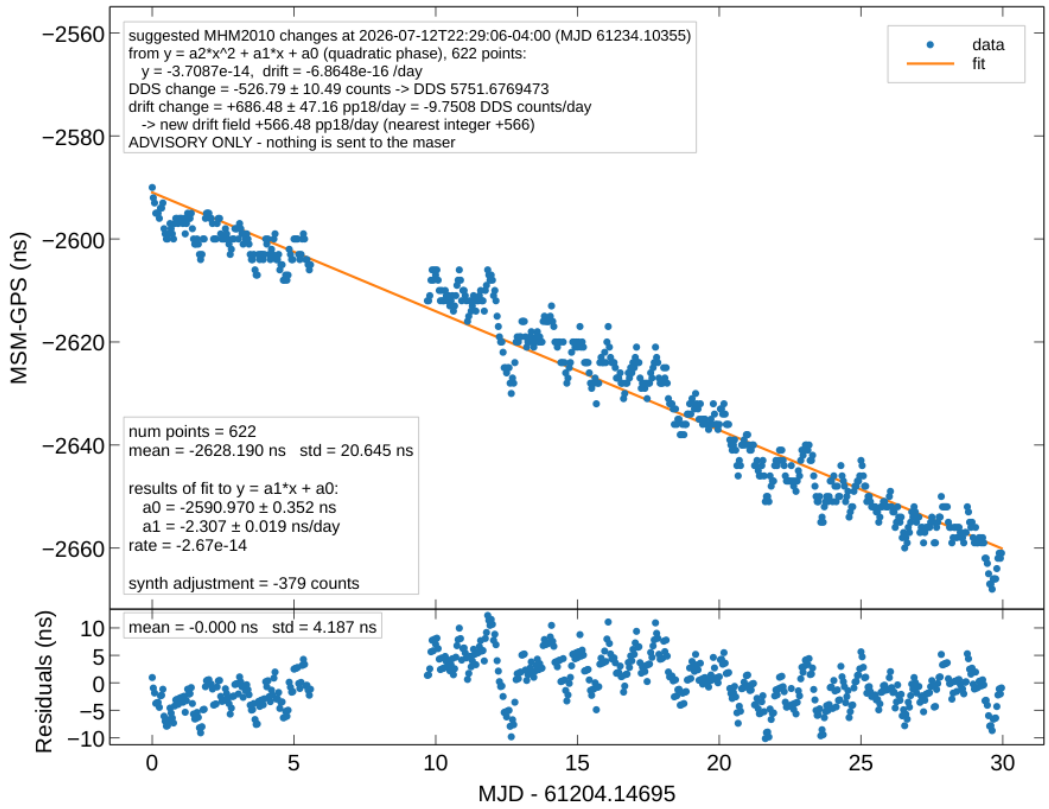
Where the two changes are stated

Place	Content
Fit & corrections, Results	"SUGGESTED CHANGES": the box text plus the exact values and notes; below, the new absolute settings when the current DDS and drift are entered
1 PPS reference plots, fit figure	box "suggested ... changes" at the upper left; the y axis leaves room above the data so the box never covers points
`analysis.vszh5`	the same box on `Ref1PPS_<channel>_fit_MJD` and `_fit_local`; datasets `Suggested_<maser>_*` (one value each, exact), `_full_precision_text`, `_box_text`
`analysis.json`, `review.md`	`suggested_settings`; exact-value table
`analyze_maser.py`	printed `suggested_settings`

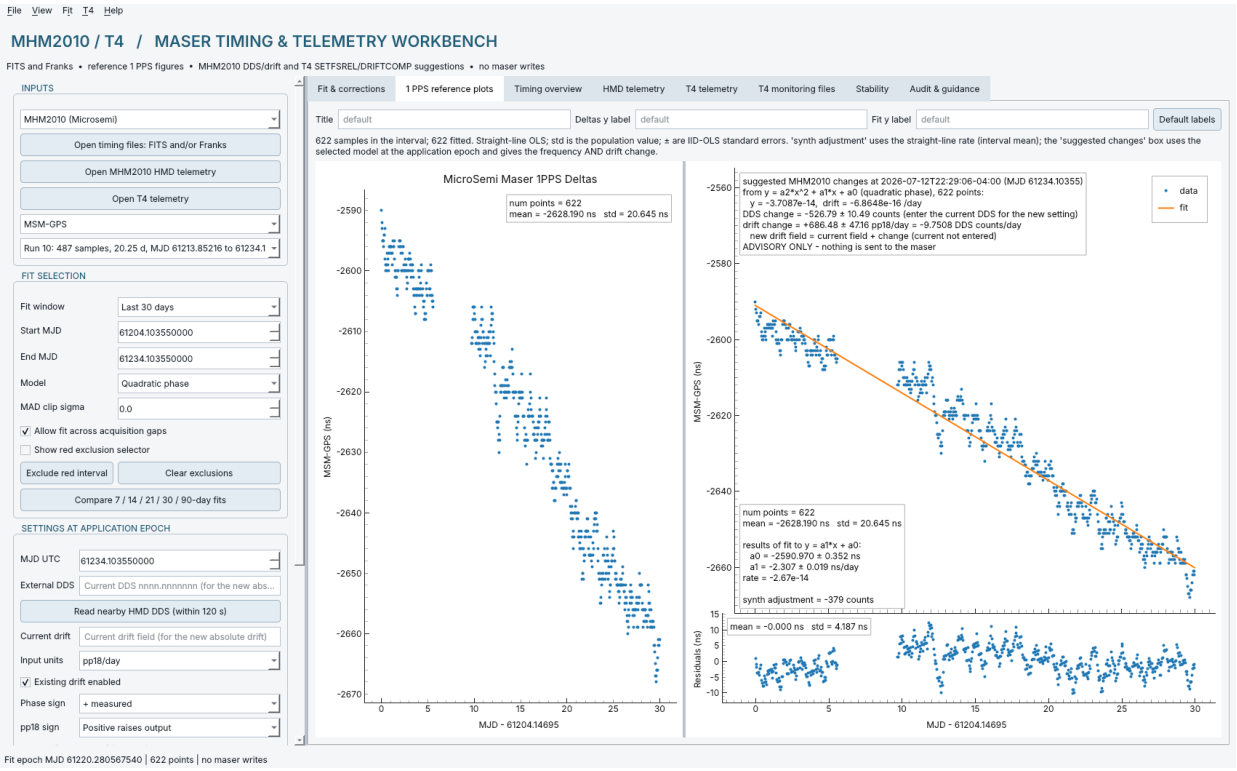
Example: last 30 days of the 2026 Franks MSM-GPS data

- Quadratic phase, 622 points; epoch `2026-07-12T22:29:06-04:00` (MJD 61234.10355).
- $y = -3.708732994065008 \times 10^{-14}$; $D = -6.864816602325095 \times 10^{-16}$/day.
- **DDS change** -526.79 ± 10.49 **counts; drift change** $+686.48 \pm 47.16$ **pp18/day** $= -9.7508$ **DDS counts/day** (positive pp18 raises the output).
- With DDS 5751.6770000 and drift -120 pp18/day: new DDS 5751.6769473 and new drift field $+566.48$ pp18/day.

The straight-line "synth adjustment" of the same figure is -379.26 counts (interval-mean rate); the quadratic gives -392.00 counts at the mean sample time (MJD 61220.28; uneven sampling around the 5-day gap) and -526.79 at the end, $13.82\,\mathrm{d} \times 9.75$ counts/day later. The $\pm$ values are conditional OLS uncertainties; GPS and colored noise are not included.



Veusz 3.6.2 render of `Ref1PPS_MSM_GPS_fit_MJD`: the figure's results box (lower left) and the suggested-changes box (upper left).



The GUI with empty DDS and drift fields: both changes are stated.

Review boundary. Enter only reviewed values. Confirm the pp18 sign convention of the installed masermon, the channel sign, the epoch and the maser state; the HMD shows whether a drift is already acting on the DDS.

Exports: names, tags and full precision

No rounding

Numeric datasets are float64. Numbers written as text use the shortest decimal that reads back to the same binary64 value (Python `repr`, at most 17 significant digits [15]); CSV files are written by pandas without a float format and read back bit-identical (tested). Earlier releases wrote the T4 CSVs with `%.6g` (5751.6770000 became 5751.68) and shortened file hashes in the notes; both are fixed. Figure boxes keep the figure layout; every number in them is also a one-element dataset and a line in `_results_full_precision_text`.

Veusz's Data-editor table displays any float with 6 significant digits (Qt's default display; Veusz 3.6.2 `dialogs/dataeditdialog.py`) although the file holds every digit: double-click a cell, or open a `*_text` dataset. Axes now use the tick format `%.12Vg` (up to 12 digits; Veusz's automatic `%Vg` shows MJD 60975 as 6.0975×10^4).

Names

Dataset (examples)	Meaning
`Franks_MSM_GPS_phase_ns`, `FITS_Site1Hz_to_CNS_GPS1_phase_ns`	every input channel
`Selected_MSM_GPS_time_MJD_UTC`, `_time_local`, `_phase_ns`	the analysed channel
`Fit_MSM_GPS_model_phase_ns`, `_residual_ns`, `_used_in_fit_flag`	the selected model
`Ref1PPS_MSM_GPS_deltas_ns`, `_fit_line_ns`, `_fit_a1_ns_per_day`	reference figures and their numbers
`Suggested_MHM2010_dds_change_counts`, `_drift_change_pp18_per_day`	suggested changes
`HMD_ExtSynth_32`, `HMD_ExtSynth_32_change_counts`, `_text`	HMD telemetry
`T4log_MonitHCB_Internal_temperature_degC`	T4 monitoring file
`T4_MONIT_ch05_<short>_V`, `_code`	T4 MONIT telemetry
`Stability_ADEV_tau_s`, `_deviation`	stability

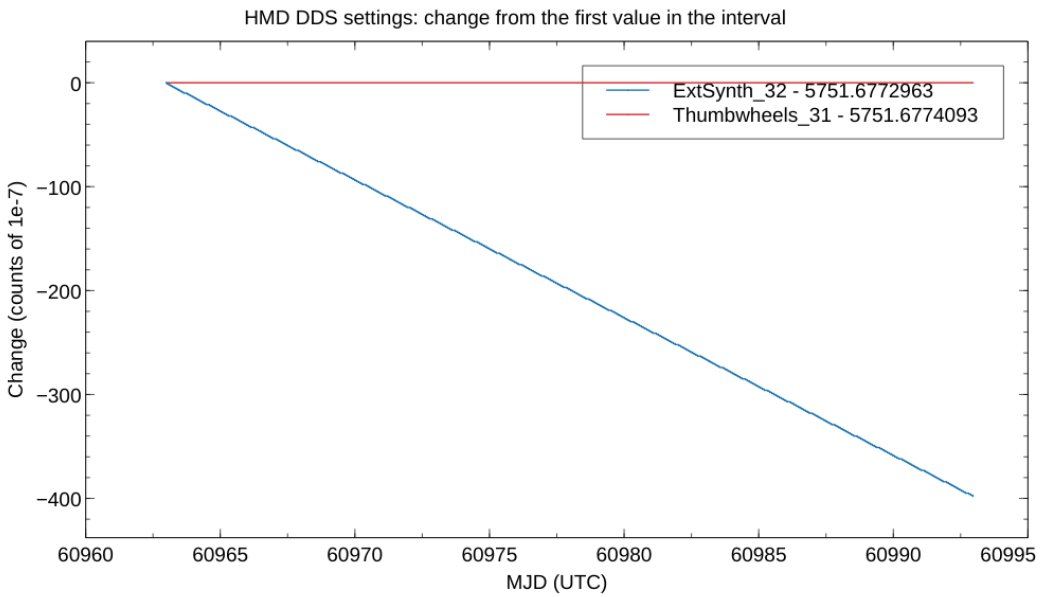
Names use letters, digits and _ only, so each is also a Veusz expression. With writer 0.0.27 the traces take the y dataset name and graphs `g_<y>`, so the widget tree reads like the data.

Tags

Every dataset carries one `source_*` tag (`Franks`, `FITS`, `HMD`, `T4_MONIT_UDP`, `T4_log_<layout>`, `Workbench`) and one or more `type_*` tags (`time_MJD`, `time_local`, `time_text`, `measurement`, `fit_model`, `fit_residual`, `fit_results`, `suggested_settings`, `telemetry`, `status`, `stability`, `reference_figure`, ...). In Veusz choose Data → *Group by: Tags*; a dataset appears under each of its tags [14].

HMD telemetry

The analysis export now holds every HMD column over the fit interval, the DDS columns (`ExtSynth_32`, `Thumbwheels_31`) also as a change in counts from the first value and as exact text, pages for the DDS change and setting, and overview pages of ten panels. In the historical example (Oct.–Nov. 2025) `ExtSynth_32` falls by about 13 counts/day while `Thumbwheels_31` stays at 5751.6774093, which suggests the drift setting acting on the DDS (inference, not confirmed with the manual).



What is new in release 0.2.2

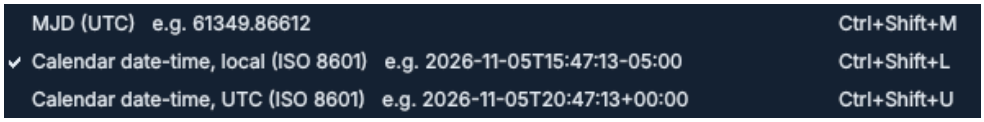
- **View → Time display (axes, dates, ranges)**: MJD (UTC), calendar date-time local, or calendar date-time UTC, both ISO 8601 (e.g. `2026-11-05T15:47:13-05:00`). One choice drives every time axis, every date field, the run list and the result text (next section).
- **Fit windows**: "Fit window" presets and a Fit menu with the last 7, 14, 30 and 90 days or all data, each offered only when the loaded data span it; comparison now includes 90 days.
- **Veusz output named**: File → Export analysis folder (Veusz .vszh5, CSV, JSON, Stable32) and Export T4 data (Veusz .vszh5, CSV, JSON); afterwards a dialog gives the `.vszh5` path with Open in Veusz and Open folder (section "Where the Veusz files are").
- MJD tick labels keep the decimals the spacing needs (61349.71, not 61349.7 twice); plot titles are readable in the Light theme.

Time display: MJD or ISO 8601 calendar time

Use

Choose **View → Time display (axes, dates, ranges)**:

Menu entry	Example	Shortcut
MJD (UTC)	`61349.86612`	Ctrl+Shift+M
Calendar date-time, local (ISO 8601)	`2026-11-05T15:47:13-05:00`	Ctrl+Shift+L
Calendar date-time, UTC (ISO 8601)	`2026-11-05T20:47:13+00:00`	Ctrl+Shift+U



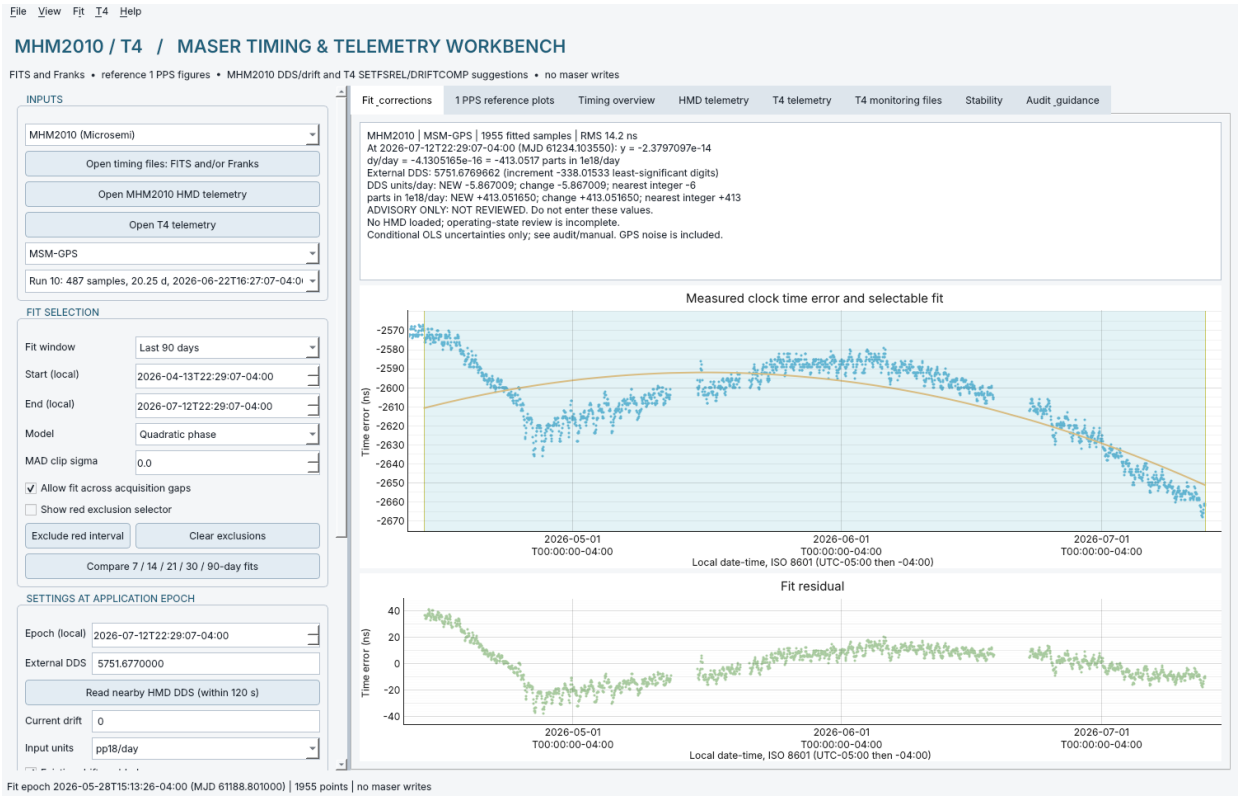
The choice applies at once to: the fit, residual, HMD, overview, reference-figure, T4 telemetry and T4 monitoring-file axes; the Start, End and application-epoch fields (they show and accept the chosen form); the run list; the result text and status bar (calendar times keep the MJD in brackets for the audit trail); and audit messages. It is remembered in `workbench_view.ini` beside the program and saved with the analysis settings. The data, fits and exported numbers are always MJD (UTC); only the display changes. The `.vszh5` always contains every time page against both MJD and local ISO time.

Typing a time. In calendar modes a field accepts `2026-11-05T15:47:13-05:00`, the one-digit offset `-5:00`, `Z`, a date alone, a time without offset (read as local in local mode, UTC in UTC mode) or a plain MJD. Up/down steps one hour (one day in MJD mode). The batch script's `--start`/`--end` accept the same forms (no offset = UTC).

Conversion and ticks

$$t^{\mathrm{Unix}} = (\mathrm{MJD} - 40587) \times 86400\ \mathrm{s}, \qquad t^{\mathrm{local}} = t^{\mathrm{Unix}} + \Delta_{\mathrm{local}}(t^{\mathrm{Unix}}),$$

with Δ_{local} the computer's UTC offset at that instant (-4 h in summer, -5 h in winter at Green Bank), so a July time shows `-04:00` and a November time `-05:00`. Ticks fall on round calendar times (pyqtgraph's date logic, daylight-saving aware) and are labelled with the full ISO time on two lines (date, then `Thh:mm:ss`$\pm$`hh:mm`); ticks closer than one label width are dropped so labels never overlap. The axis title gives the offsets in the range, e.g. "Local date-time, ISO 8601 (UTC$-$05:00 then $-$04:00)". "Julian" in common speech often means this calendar view; strictly, MJD is the Julian-day count (JD$-$2 400 000.5) and the calendar dates are Gregorian.



Local ISO 8601 display, last 90 days of the 2026 Franks MSM-GPS channel (Light theme).

Fit windows: last 30 and 90 days

FIT SELECTION → **Fit window** (or the **Fit** menu) sets the blue interval to the last 7, 14, 30 or 90 days ending at the last sample, or to all data, and moves the application epoch to the last sample. A preset is enabled only when the loaded channel spans it (its tooltip gives the span otherwise). If the window contains acquisition gaps, "Allow fit across acquisition gaps" is switched on and logged; check the plot for phase steps. Dragging the blue interval returns to "Custom". **Compare 7/14/21/30/90-day fits** (or Fit → Compare window lengths) fits each trailing window ending at the selected end, skipping windows longer than the data; results go to the audit tab. In batch, `--last-days 30` or `90` does the same and stops if the data are shorter.

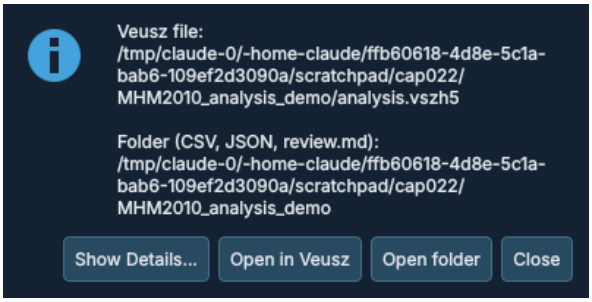
On the 2026 Franks MSM-GPS data (193 days), the 90-day quadratic window ending 2026-07-13 02:29 UTC gives $y = -2.38 \times 10^{-14}$ and drift -413 parts in 10^{18}/day with 14.2 ns RMS; the 30-day window gives $y = -3.71 \times 10^{-14}$, -686 parts in 10^{18}/day and 3.6 ns RMS. The difference is the window sensitivity this comparison exists to expose; the 90-day window spans gaps and a visible phase excursion in April.

Where the Veusz files are

The `.vszh5` files are written only by an export, always into a *new* folder:

Action	Result
File → Export analysis folder (Ctrl+E), or OUTPUT → "Export analysis: Veusz .vszh5 + CSV/JSON"	`<parent>/<MHM2010|T4>_analysis_<YYYYMMDDTHHMMSS±hhmm>/analysis.vszh5` (needs a valid fit)
File → Export T4 data (Ctrl+Shift+E), or the T4 tabs' export buttons	`<parent>/T4_telemetry_export_<time>/t4_telemetry.vszh5`
`analyze_maser.py …--output DIR`	`DIR/analysis.vszh5` (path printed as `veusz_file`)
`t4_native.py FILES --output DIR`	`DIR/t4_telemetry.vszh5`

After a GUI export a dialog shows the full path with **Open in Veusz** and **Open folder**; "Open last export in Veusz" (OUTPUT box and File menu) reopens it. Veusz is looked for at the path set with File → Set Veusz program, then on PATH, then in `Program Files\Veusz`; if not found, the program asks once. Veusz 3.6 or later opens `.vszh5` directly.



What is new in release 0.2.1

- **T4 monitoring files**: the LAN module's own logs from FTP `./Monitoring` (e.g. `MonitHCB.dat`) are read by `t4_native.py` 0.0.1, shown in a new tab "T4 monitoring files", exported (CSV, JSON, `.vszh5` against MJD and local time) and added to analysis bundles. Format, time base and the clock-not-set rule are in the next sections.
- **Local UDP port 14000** by default for live T4 polling (GUI and command line).
- **Operator script** `tools/T4_Reboot.py` 0.0.4 with loopback tests (it is not part of the workbench, which still sends no settings).
- **Corrections**: REBOOT restarts the M&C software ([9], Table 1, p. 8); manual section and page citations checked page by page.

What is new in release 0.2.0

- **T4 iMaser 3000**: maser selector; SETFSREL and DRIFTCOMP suggestions from the OEM relations [8], [9]; a T4 telemetry tab that reads recorder files and text logs and can poll the maser with read-only queries; a loopback emulator for tests and demonstrations.
- **Reference 1 PPS figures**: the operator's two figures (deltas with statistics; data and fit over residuals) in the GUI and as the first pages of every `analysis.vszh5`.
- **FITS and Franks together**: one selection may hold both; they remain separate series. Franks month-boundary repeats are resolved and reported; fits may bridge gaps.
- **Time axes**: every time-series page exists against MJD (UTC) and against the local date-time of the processing computer, with ISO 8601 tick labels [12] (writer 0.0.24).
- **GUI**: menu bar (File, View with Light/Dark theme, T4, Help).

Reference 1 PPS figures

Definitions

For the N samples of a figure, $x_i = \mathrm{MJD}_i - \mathrm{MJD}_0$ (days, MJD_0 the first sample shown) and y_i is the 1 PPS time difference in ns. The deltas figure uses every sample of the selected interval; the fit figure uses the samples actually fitted (operator exclusions removed, drawn hollow and grey). The boxes report

$$\bar{y} = \frac{1}{N}\sum_i y_i, \qquad \mathrm{std} = \sqrt{\frac{1}{N}\sum_i (y_i - \bar{y})^2} \quad \text{(population value, as } \texttt{numpy.std}\text{)}.$$

Straight-line fit and its standard errors

With $\bar{x}$, $S_{xx} = \sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2$ and $S_{xy} = \sum (x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})$, the least-squares line $y = a_1 x + a_0$ minimizes $\sum r_i^2$, $r_i = y_i - a_1 x_i - a_0$. Setting $\partial/\partial a_0 = \partial/\partial a_1 = 0$ gives the normal equations, whose solution is

$$a_1 = \frac{S_{xy}}{S_{xx}}, \qquad a_0 = \bar{y} - a_1 \bar{x}.$$

For independent residuals of variance σ^2, $\mathrm{Var}(a_1) = \sigma^2 / S_{xx}$; because $\mathrm{Cov}(\bar{y}, a_1) = 0$, $\mathrm{Var}(a_0) = \mathrm{Var}(\bar{y}) + \bar{x}^2 \,\mathrm{Var}(a_1) = \sigma^2 \left(\frac{1}{N} + \frac{\bar{x}^2}{S_{xx}} \right)$. With $s^2 = \sum r_i^2 / (N-2)$ in place of σ^2:

$$s(a_1) = \frac{s}{\sqrt{S_{xx}}}, \qquad s(a_0) = s\sqrt{\frac{1}{N} + \frac{\bar{x}^2}{S_{xx}}}, \qquad \mathrm{rate} = r = \frac{a_1\,[\mathrm{ns/day}] \times 10^{-9}}{86400\ \mathrm{s}}.$$

These are conditional IID errors; colored noise and GPS systematics are not included [2]. Check against the operator's figure: $N = 741$, $s = 3.49$ ns over 31 days gives $S_{xx} \approx 741 \times 31^2/12$, $s(a_1) \approx 0.014$ ns/day and $s(a_0) \approx 0.257$ ns, as printed.

Synthesizer adjustment line

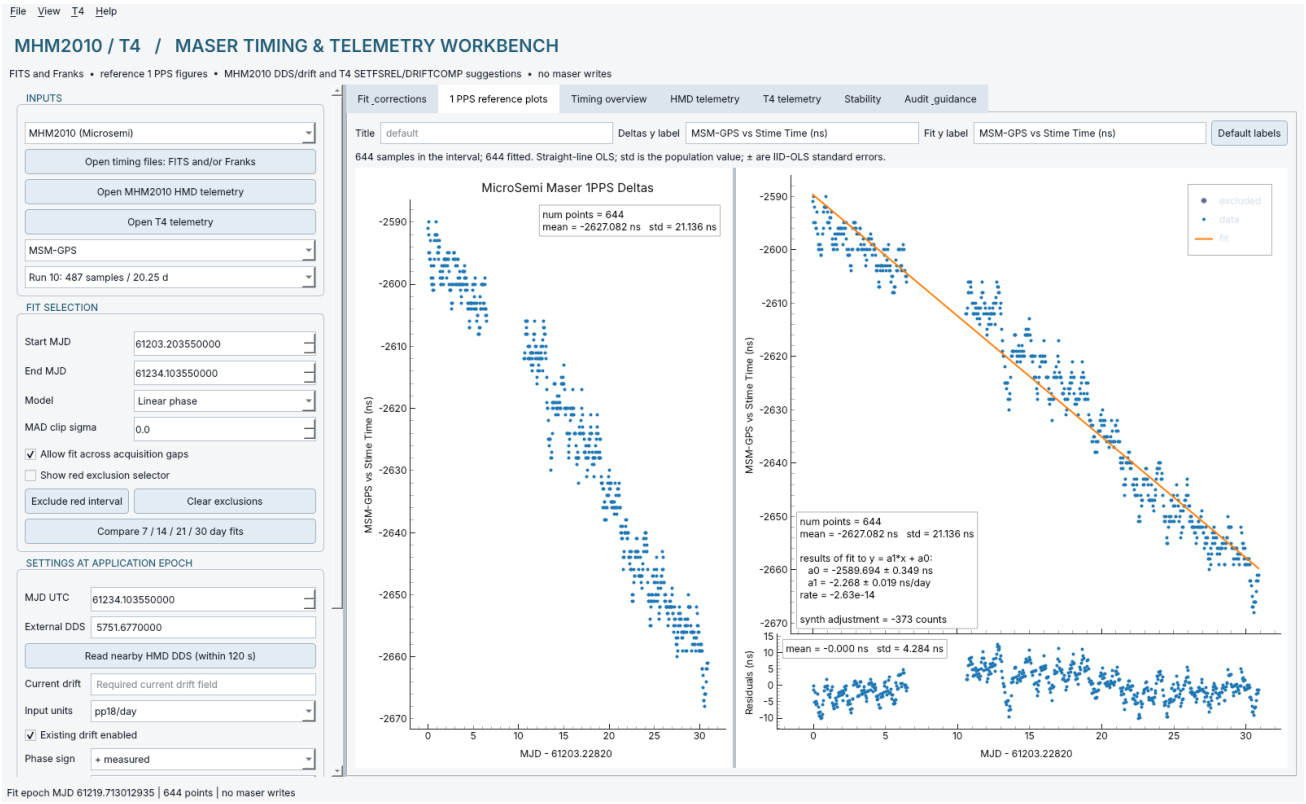
MHM2010. Appendix A gives the fractional change per DDS unit, $\partial y/\partial D = -2 \times 10^{-7}/(284.08 + 2 \times 10^{-7} D)$ [1]. One count is 10^{-7} DDS units, so cancelling $y = \sigma r$ ($\sigma = \pm 1$ the phase sign) requires

$$\Delta n = \frac{-\sigma r}{-2 \times 10^{-14}/(284.08 + 2 \times 10^{-7} D)} = \frac{\sigma r\,(284.08 + 2 \times 10^{-7} D)}{2 \times 10^{-14}}.$$

For $r = -3.15 \times 10^{-14}$ this is -447 counts, the value in the operator's figure; the full DDS calculation of Appendix A agrees to 10^{-9} relative (test suite).

T4. The line shows the SETFSREL entry and the synthesizer change of the next section for the same straight-line rate.

Review boundary. The figure's adjustment uses the straight-line mean rate over the plotted span, as the operator's figures do. The settings panel evaluates the selected model (linear or quadratic) at the application epoch. With a quadratic fit the two can differ; enter only the reviewed settings-panel values.



GUI tab “1 PPS reference plots” (Light theme) on the operator’s Franks files, June–July 2026, MSM-GPS.

FITS and Franks inputs together

- FITS series are raw channel pairs keyed “A -> B”; Franks series are hourly medians keyed by column (e.g. `MSM-GPS`). Keys cannot collide; nothing is merged or interpolated.
- **Month boundaries.** Consecutive `YYYY_MM.t00new` files repeat the first hours of the next month. Identical repeats are dropped. A disagreeing repeat (found in the supplied files at MJD 61222.01917, Site1Hz 0 vs 1) keeps the row from the file named for that row’s month, and the conflict is listed in the audit tab.
- **Gaps.** The 0.1.0 rule refused a fit across an acquisition gap. “Allow fit across acquisition gaps” (default on for Franks data) fits through gaps and reports each one. The supplied 2026 MSM-GPS series has nine gaps of 5 to 99 h; inspect the residuals for a phase step.

T4 iMaser 3000

MONIT telemetry

The reply to `MONIT;` is `$` + 113 hexadecimal characters + CR LF (Type 1, Card FPGA T4S-724) or CR (Type 2, IO card LAN T4S-711) [8]. The channels are 32 of 12 bits, 8 of 8 bits and the main-PLL lock bit:

$$L_{\text{hex}} = 32 \cdot 3 + 8 \cdot 2 + 1 = 113, \qquad v_i = g_i\, c_i, \quad c_i = \texttt{int}(\text{field}_i, 16)\ \text{(unsigned)}.$$

Gains g_i are Table 6 of [8], identical to the operator’s repository table [10]; the -15 V rail has a negative gain. Channels 21, 37 and 39 are “Not used”. Channel 40 (LOCK 100 MHz) is an 8-bit analog voltage; channel 41 is the lock bit (1 locked, 0 unlocked; any other code is flagged). Decoding the manual’s example reply gives 4.765 V for channel 40; the operator’s web-page screenshot shows 4.764 V.

Inputs. The recorder's `t4_raw_frames.csv` (re-decoded from the raw replies), its `t4_telemetry.csv` (raw codes re-scaled), or text logs with one `<time> $<frame>` per line. Times must be MJD or ISO 8601 with an offset.

Live polling (T4 tab) sends only `MONIT;`, `RDFS;`, `GETID;` and `RDREG=…;` over UDP port 14000 [9]. Each attempt uses a fresh socket with bounded retries; datagrams from other peers are ignored. Since 0.2.1 the local UDP port defaults to 14000 for a real T4: the vendor example and `T4_Maser_Comms.py` bind it ("seems one must bind the port to local port as well" [10]), so the T4 probably answers to port 14000 rather than to the sender's port; the manual does not say. The emulator uses an ephemeral port. Raw replies are written before decoding, into a folder stamped once at creation (`T4_telemetry_YYYYMMDDTHHMMSS±hhmm`). The preview buffer is bounded and can be flushed or offloaded to a pickle. A non-loopback address requires the approval box. "Use loopback emulator" serves the manual's example reply.

Frequency setting: SETFSREL

The PLL forces the last IF to equal the synthesizer frequency, $\nu_{\text{synth}} = F_{\text{out}} - 284\,\nu_{\text{ocxo}}$, and the output is the 5 MHz OCXO, $\nu_0 = \nu_{\text{ocxo}} = (F_{\text{out}} - \nu_{\text{synth}})/284$ ([8], Eqs. 10–11). Differentiating at fixed F_{out}:

$$y_0 = \frac{\Delta\nu_0}{\nu_0} = \frac{-\Delta\nu_{\text{synth}}}{284 \times 5\ \text{MHz}} = \frac{-\Delta\nu_{\text{synth}}}{1.42 \times 10^9\ \text{Hz}} \qquad \text{(Eq. 12)}.$$

To cancel a measured offset y the output must change by $\Delta y = -y$, so $\Delta\nu_{\text{synth}} = y \times 1.42 \times 10^9$ Hz. The synthesizer resolution is 39 bits of 5 MHz (Sec. 9.4), $\delta = 5\ \text{MHz}/2^{39} = 9.0949 \times 10^{-6}$ Hz (6.405×10^{-15} relative). The suggestion is quantized:

$$n = \text{round}\left(\frac{\Delta\nu_{\text{synth}}}{\delta}\right), \qquad \Delta y_{\text{realized}} = -\frac{n\,\delta}{1.42 \times 10^9\ \text{Hz}}, \qquad \texttt{SETFSREL} = \pm\Delta y_{\text{realized}}.$$

[9] defines SETFSREL as a relative step in s/s with a mandatory sign (range $\pm 29 \times 10^{-9}$), but not whether + raises the output. The selector "SETFSREL sign" sets the convention, and the panel predicts the new `RDFS` value, $\nu_{\text{synth}} + n\delta$, which must lie within 405 708–405 795 Hz. **After entry, compare RDFS with the prediction**; a move in the opposite direction means the convention is reversed. RDFS values near 1.42 GHz (the web page's FREQ) are reduced by 1.42×10^9 Hz.

Drift: DRIFTCOMP

With linear drift, $y(t) = y_0 + \dot{y}t$ and $x(t) = x_0 + y_0 t + \frac{1}{2}\dot{y}t^2$ ([8], Eqs. 22–23). The quadratic phase fit $x = c_0 + c_1 d + c_2 d^2$ (ns, days) gives $y = (c_1 + 2c_2 d) \times 10^{-9}/86400$ and a drift per day $\dot{y}_{\text{day}} = 2c_2 \times 10^{-9}/86400$. "A positive sign will generate a positive slope compensation" [9], so

$$\texttt{DRIFTCOMP}_{\text{new}} = \texttt{DRIFTCOMP}_{\text{now}} - \sigma\,\dot{y}_{\text{day}}, \qquad 10^{-17} < |\texttt{DRIFTCOMP}| < 8 \times 10^{-13},$$

followed by REBOOT, which "Reboot[s] the M&C software" ([9], Table 1, p. 8), and `RDREG=DRIFTCOMP;` to verify. Neither command removes the 1 PPS time offset (ADJ1PPS/SYNCPPS).

Demonstration (MSM-GPS used as a stand-in, *not* T4 data)	Value
Fit: last 30.9 d of 2026 Franks MSM-GPS, quadratic, gap bridged	644 samples
y at MJD 61234.10355	-3.7365×10^{-14}
$\Delta\nu_{\text{synth}}$, steps	$-54.570\ \mu$Hz, -6
Suggested entry ("+ raises output")	`SETFSREL=+3.843E-14;`
RDFS before → predicted after	405750.927598720 → 405750.927544150 Hz
Drift entry (current 0)	`DRIFTCOMP=+7.11e-16;`

Review boundary. No FITS pair or Franks column is identified as the T4 yet. Designate the channel in the GUI ("Selected channel is the T4 comparison") or with `--maser T4 --channel`. T4 settings stay blocked until the channel is designated.

T4 monitoring files (FTP ./Monitoring)

What the manual says

RECMONIT=<s>; records the monitoring "in a file stored on the local SD memory card"; the file "can be accessed by FTP under the directory ./Monitoring"; at 2 MB it "is copied with a tag of the date and time, and the current file is reset" ([9], Sec. 1.1.3, p. 12; Sec. 6.5, p. 22). RECMONIT appears only in Sec. 1.1.3, not in the Table 1 command list. The web page shows only whether recording is ON or OFF (Sec. 1.1.3, p. 12; Sec. 4, p. 20). Each record is tagged with the module's date and time, set by NTP or SETDATE/SETTIME; without synchronisation at power-up the clock is not kept (pp. 12, 22). Option telemetry such as the HCB is recorded in these files although MONIT does not return it (p. 14). The FTP login is in Sec. 6.1 (p. 21). The manual does not document file names, columns or the record layout.

Format, as found in the GBO file

Property	MonitHCB.dat, GBO T4, received 2026-11-05
Layout	Tab-separated; CR LF; header TIME then Label [unit] per column
Encoding	UTF-8; the degree sign arrived as U+FFFD (bytes EF BF BD) and is repaired to °
Time	DD/MM/YY HH:MM:SS, UTC, 1 s resolution
Records	84: 10 before the time-server sync (3 stamped 2006-01-16, 7 stamped 2007-06-06), then 74 from 17:13:09 to 18:25:39 UTC
Interval	median 60 s, mean 59.59 s, range 59–62 s
Columns	Set, Internal and External temperature [°C]; Alarm Status (text)

Date order. 16/01/06 cannot be MM/DD (no month 16), and YY/MM/DD would date the newest records to 2005. The last record, 05/11/26 18:25:39, was 1.5 min before the file reached this computer (13:27 EST = 18:27 UTC), consistent with UTC as the operator stated. DMY is the default; the reader warns when another order would read every line that the chosen order cannot (a wrong order can still read most lines: 05/11/26 is a valid MM/DD/YY).

Time base. With t^{Unix} the record time in seconds since 1970-01-01 UTC,

$$\mathrm{MJD} = \frac{t^{\mathrm{Unix}}}{86400\ \mathrm{s}} + 40587,$$

so 2026-11-05 17:13:09 UTC is MJD $61349 + \frac{62\,089}{86\,400} = 61349.717465$. These are the maser's own stamps (unlike MONIT rows, which carry this computer's receive time) and may be compared with timing data directly.

Clock not set

A record is *clock-valid* if $t_{\mathrm{min}} \le t \le t_{\mathrm{now}} + 1$ d, with t_{min} = 2020-01-01 UTC by default ("Clock valid from" in the tab, --t4-earliest-valid in batch). Other records are listed in the table and CSV (greyed, clock_valid=0, with their file and line) but never plotted or analysed. Runs of such records are reported separately; a new run starts at a jump of more than 1 h or backwards. Interval statistics use clock-valid records only: for successive stamps t_k, $\Delta_k = t_{k+1} - t_k$, the median, mean, minimum and maximum of Δ_k, the count of $\Delta_k < 0$, and the count of $\Delta_k > 1.5\,\mathrm{median}(\Delta)$ (gaps).

HCB columns

HCB is the Active Heater-Cooler-Box option (climatic chamber) [13]; the SMC unit sets the temperature of the liquid circulating in its tubes (SETTEMPHCB). The HTML page shows "the setting of the

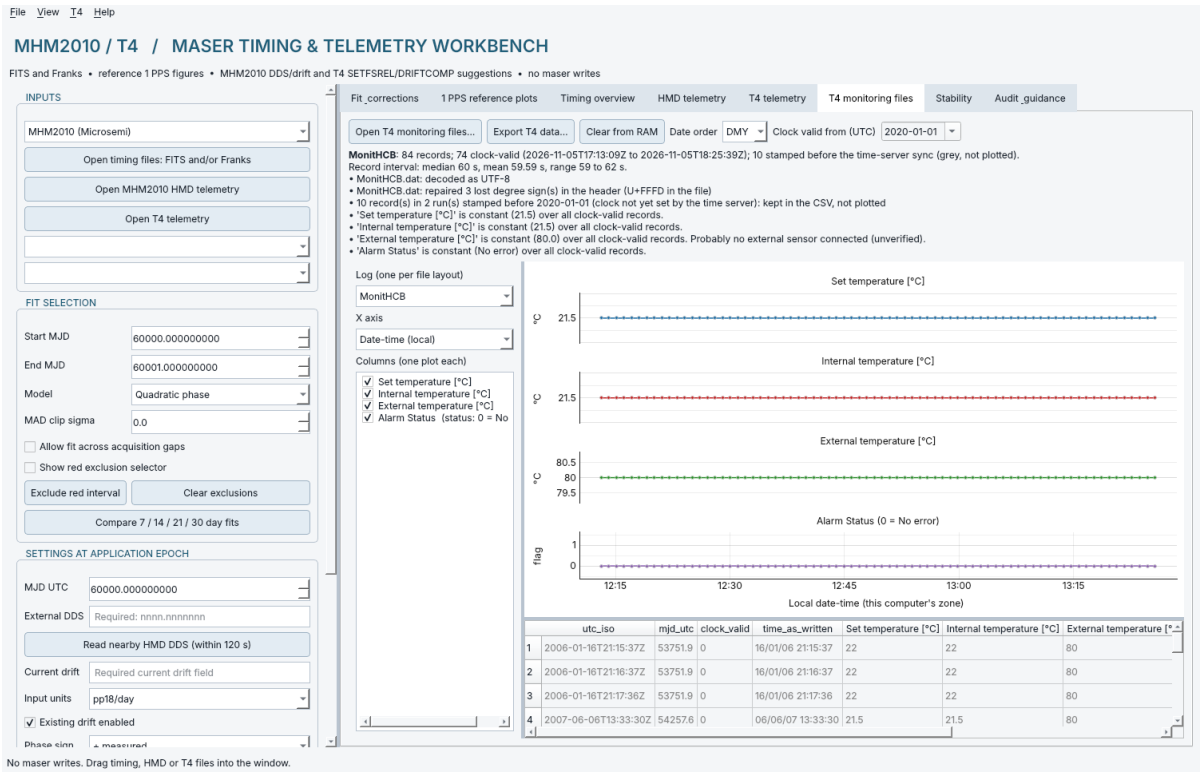
temperature", "the internal temperature sensor used for regulation", "the external temperature sensor if used" and "the operation status normal or Alarm (the error code of the error will be displayed)" ([9], Sec. 1.1.3, p. 16). In the GBO file, set point and internal temperature are 21.5 °C throughout the clock-valid span (22 °C in the 2006 pre-sync records), the external temperature is a constant 80 °C, and the status is "No error". A constant 80 °C suggests that no external sensor is connected; this is an inference, not confirmed. Status text is kept as written and plotted as a flag: 0 for "No error", 1 otherwise.

Reading several files

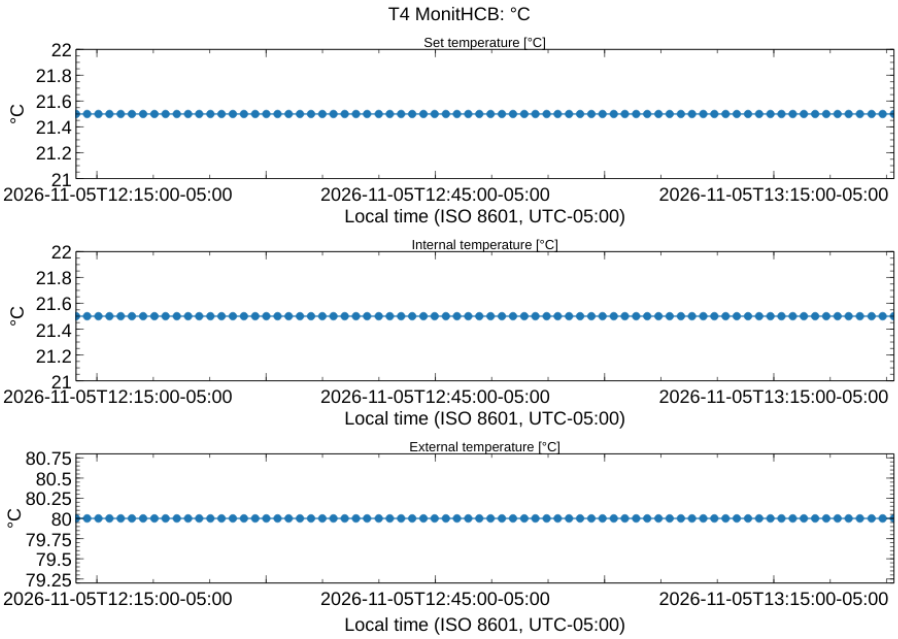
Files with the same header (the live file and its rolled, date-tagged copies) are merged in order of their latest record, so a pre-sync 2006 stamp cannot put the newest file first. Identical records (same time and values) are kept once; records with the same time but different values are kept and reported. Files with different headers stay separate logs. Files are read in parallel threads; at most 2 MB each [9], they need no special memory handling, and "Clear from RAM" releases them.

Outputs and use

- **GUI**: open with File → Open T4 telemetry or monitoring files (Ctrl+T), the T4 menu, or drag and drop; files are routed by content (a tab-separated header starting with `TIME`). The tab shows one x-linked plot per column against MJD − MJD_0, UTC or local date-time, the summary and notes, and every record.
- **Export**: `t4_<layout>_records.csv` (every record, clock flag, source line; UTF-8 with BOM), `t4_telemetry.json`, and `t4_telemetry.vszh5` with one panel per column (each with its own range, padded by 10 % or ± 0.5 when constant), a status page and a notes page, each against MJD − MJD_0 and against local ISO time.
- **Batch**: `analyze_maser.py --t4-telemetry MonitHCB.dat …` adds the pages to `analysis.vszh5`; `python t4_native.py MonitHCB.dat --output NEW_DIR` exports only the monitoring files.



Tab "T4 monitoring files" (Light theme, local date-time axis) on the GBO `MonitHCB.dat`.



Veusz 3.6.2 render of the exported page against local ISO time (EST).

Review boundary. The format is inferred from one HCB file. The main 40-channel monitoring file has not been seen; the reader is header-driven and should read it if it has the same layout, but this is untested. HCB alarm codes are not documented here.

Operator script: tools/T4_Reboot.py

The workbench sends no settings and no REBOOT. `tools/T4_Reboot.py` 0.0.4 is a separate operator script that reboots the M&C software after checks; it is untested on a real T4.

1. Read-only checks `GETID;`, `RDFS;`, `RDREG=DRIFTCOMP;` from local port 14000. Each answer must start with `$` and the command; `!<command>` is a rejection ([9], Sec. 1.1.2, p. 11). Any failure stops the script before REBOOT.
2. The operator types `REBOOT`; the command is sent once. Table 1 lists no answer, so silence is the expected result; `!REBOOT` stops the script.
3. After 30 s (the manual's wait after a front-panel reset, Sec. 6.7, p. 24; none is given for REBOOT) the checks are repeated and compared. RDFS may change on its own when drift compensation steps the synthesizer.

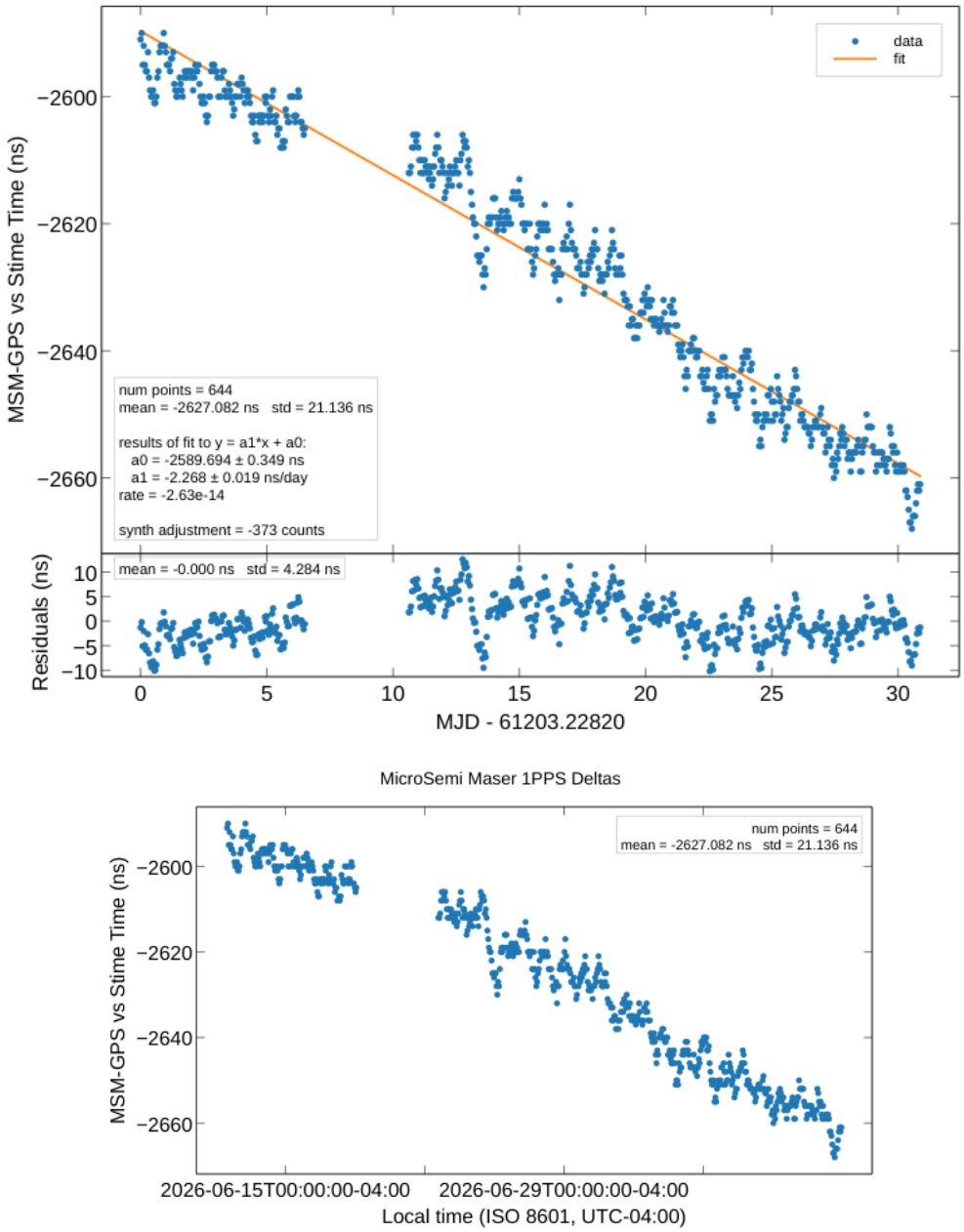
Exit codes: 0 success or cancelled, 1 pre-check failed (nothing sent), 2 post-check failed, 3 REBOOT rejected or not sent. The original 0.0.1 script waited for a reply to REBOOT and therefore ended with `TimeoutError` even when the reboot worked (reproduced on loopback). Sec. 1.1.3 (p. 13) describes REBOOT as "Reset the LAN module" and Sec. 6.7 (p. 24) says the equivalent telnet reset "will not affect the stability or the 1PPS generation"; confirm 1 PPS after a reboot.

MJD and local ISO 8601 time axes

Veusz stores dates as naive seconds from 2009-01-01; a local wall-clock axis is therefore

$$V_i = t_i^{\mathrm{Unix}} - 1\,230\,768\,000\ \mathrm{s} + \Delta_{\mathrm{local}}(t_i), \qquad t^{\mathrm{Unix}} = (\mathrm{MJD} - 40587) \times 86400\ \mathrm{s},$$

where Δ_{local} is the processing computer's UTC offset, evaluated per sample (daylight saving aware). The tick format is `%VDY-%VDm-%VDdT%VDH:%VDM:%VDS` followed by the offset, e.g. `2026-11-03T06:31:15-05:00`. Veusz formats are static, so when the data cross a DST change the ticks omit the offset and the axis label lists each offset and when it begins. Each time-series page is written twice (`…_mjd`, `…_local`); the reference figures keep the operator's MJD $-$ MJD$_0$ axis and gain `pps_deltas_local` and `pps_fit_local`. Writer helpers: `mjd_to_epoch`, `local_time_axis`, `iso_local_strings`, `time_pair_pages`.



Rendered by Veusz 3.6.2 from `analysis.vszh5`: fit page against MJD $-$ MJD$_0$, and the deltas twin against local ISO time (EDT in June).

Validation of release 0.2.3

Check	Result
Test suite (Python 3.13.18, PySide6 6.12.0, numpy 2.5.4, pandas 3.1.0, offscreen)	133 passed: 112 retained (4 updated for new names) + 21 new
Suggestions vs `correction()` / `t4_settings()`	identical DDS change and new DDS; drift change and new field equal to 10^{-13}, both units, both conventions, both signs
Known rate and drift (synthetic)	recovered within 3σ; signs as expected
Empty DDS and drift fields	both changes shown (0.2.2: none)
Exact exports	CSVs, Stable32, `review.md`, text datasets read back exactly; full SHA-256
Names and tags	every dataset `[A-Za-z][A-Za-z0-9_]*`, tagged, one source tag each
Veusz 3.6.2 renders	`validation/veusz_render_v0.2.3/`

Not validated: Windows, Veusz 4.2.1 for the new pages, a real T4.

Validation of release 0.2.2

Check	Result
Test suite (Python 3.12, PySide6 6.12.0, offscreen, TZ America/New_York)	112 passed: 103 from 0.2.1 + 9 time-display, fit-window and export tests
ISO 8601 round trip	`2026-11-05T15:47:13-5:00` → MJD 61349.866123 → `2026-11-05T15:47:13-05:00` / `20:47:13+00:00`; July shows `-04:00`
Every control follows the menu	axes, Start/End/epoch fields, run list, results, status bar, reference, T4 and monitoring tabs
Last 30 / 90 days, 2026 Franks MSM-GPS	622 / 1955 samples; 90 d needs and enables gap bridging; disabled on the 12-day July file
Batch `--start` with `-4:00` offset	runs; `veusz_file` printed; `--last-days 400` refused

Not validated: Windows (time-zone rules come from the operating system there), launching Veusz from the dialog (not installed in the test environment).

Validation of release 0.2.1

Check	Result
Test suite (Python 3.12, PySide6 6.12.0, offscreen)	103 passed: 79 from 0.2.0, 9 monitoring-file, 15 reboot-script (loopback)
GBO `MonitHCB.dat`	84 records; 74 clock-valid, 17:13:09–18:25:39 UTC; 10 pre-sync in 2 runs; interval 59–62 s
Date order	DMY reads every line; MDY loses 3 lines and the reader warns
Franks 2026 regression with the file added	unchanged: $N = 644$, $a_1 = -2.268 \pm 0.019$ ns/day, -373 counts
Veusz 3.6.2 render of the monitoring export	5 pages (per-column, status, notes; MJD and local)

Not validated: the main 40-channel monitoring file, the reply port of the real T4, and the reboot script on the real T4.

Validation of release 0.2.0

Check	Result
Test suite (Python 3.12.15, PySide6 6.12.0)	79 passed: 36 retained from 0.1.0, 29 T4, 10 reference/Franks/time/export, 4 GUI
Manual example MONIT replies (Type 1 and 2)	Decoded; channel 40 4.765 V vs 4.764 V on the web page
Franks 2026, MSM-GPS, last 30.9 d, linear	$N = 644$, $a_1 = -2.268 \pm 0.019$ ns/day, rate -2.63×10^{-14}, -373 counts (DDS calculation: -372.86)
Writer 0.0.23 master	Rebuilt byte-exact (SHA-256 `90833d76…eaac6`); 0.0.24 adds helpers only
Veusz 3.6.2 renders	25 pages incl. reference, overview and local ISO pages
UDP fault cases (emulator)	timeout, exhaustion, wrong peer, duplicate, garbage, truncation, port in use, cancellation, CR-only replies

Not validated: a real T4 (no GBO captures yet), the SETFSREL sign, Windows, Stable32 import, and Veusz 4.2.1 for the new pages.

Release checklist

- **Code**: Python 3.12 syntax, headers, revision history and Spyder cells.
- **GUI**: qtpy/PySide6, pyqtgraph, fitting, overview, HMD, stability and audit.
- **Science**: explicit phase sign, epoch, both drift units, no housekeeping-only calibration.
- **Outputs**: native HDF5, raw and reduced datasets, Stable32 and provenance.
- **Documentation**: editable LuaLaTeX, references, equations and PDF bookmarks.
- **Limits**: no live writes; Windows, masermon and Stable32 site tests remain.

Release 0.2.0 adds the T4 iMaser 3000 (read-only telemetry and advisory settings); 0.2.1 adds the T4's own monitoring files; 0.2.2 the time display and fit windows; 0.2.3 both suggested changes everywhere and exact, named, tagged exports. Site tests on the real T4 (captured MONIT replies, RDFS before and after a SETFSREL entry, the main monitoring file) and on Windows remain open; see the validation sections.

IEEE reference table

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[5]	W. W. Wallace, "RF_Equipment_Comms: sa_stability_tool," GitHub repository, reviewed commit `9305e94e9ad85dbdb94a3765cf0989449dc3f345`, accessed Nov. 3, 2026.	https://github.com/Braveheart53/RF_Equipment_Comms/tree/main/sa_stability_tool
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[10]	W. W. Wallace, "GBO_Maser_Control: T4_Maser_Comms.py, T4_channel_names.csv, T4_fromOEM.py," GitHub repository, reviewed commit `c72244d`, accessed Nov. 3, 2026.	https://github.com/Braveheart53/GBO_Maser_Control
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